# Flag 2 of 18: Compromised Referer Blog

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## Question

By analyzing web proxy logs around the time of the download, what is the domain of the compromised blog that served as the referer for the malicious update archive?

## Answer

**marketingtrends-insider.com**

## Evidence

- The alert showed `powershell.exe` launched by `wscript.exe`, so a script file had to exist before it.
- Sysmon file creation: `C:\Users\marcus.vance\Downloads\ChromeSetup.js`, created by `explorer.exe` at 20:00:16Z. Explorer creating the script means the user extracted an archive.
- Zscaler proxy event at 19:59:35Z: marcus.vance contacted `static.cdn-updater-distribution.net` (104.21.88.45). This host served the archive, so it is not the answer.
- The same event listed `https://marketingtrends-insider.com/` as the referer under "Others" in the event summary.

## How it was found

Window: Oct 15, 2026, 19:00 to 21:15 UTC.

```
re.regex(target.url, `/ChromeSetup|chrome.*update|\.zip/`) nocase
```

One result came back, and it was the archive download.

## Lesson

The destination shows where the payload was hosted. The referer shows where the user came from. The question asked for the second.

# Next pivot

Search the same host after the PowerShell execution for the secondary payload.